wealth, to the avoidance of sexual impropriety and to the renunciation of attachment to possessions. In addition, they should cultivate proper states of mind, undertake pilgrimages to sacred sites, meditate, fast and confess their failings and request forgiveness. Householders, frequently members of the merchant class, observe the Hindu ***caste*** system. Intermarriage and food sharing with Hindus is acceptable.

Actions performed out of ignorance and under the sway of the passions of anger, pride, self-deception and greed attract karmic influxes into the souls and restrict their potentialities. The purpose of religious life is to purge the soul of ***karma***.

In their quest for self-perfection and dissociation from gross and *karmic* forms of matter (***moksha***: liberation), monks undertake a rigorous discipline whose goal is the prevention of *karmic* infiltration by the control of mental, verbal and physical acts, by taking care not to harm living creatures. They exercise the virtues of patience, humility, straightforwardness, purity, honesty, restraint, austerity, renunciation, chastity and obedience to elders in the community. They reflect on the impermanence of phenomena, human helplessness, transmigration, individual solitude, the difference between soul and body, physical impurity, the actuality of *karmic* influxes, the means to blocking *karmic* influxes, individual responsibility for salvation, the rarity of enlightenment and the truth of the teaching of the saints. The elimination of already accumulated ***karma*** begins once the acquisition of fresh ***karma*** has been prevented by the discipline of self-control.

Further reading: Dundas 1992; Jaini 1979 and 2000

Jainism: a renunciatory religious movement whose goal is individual self-perfection. It is believed to have been founded by *Vardhamana Mahavira* in the latter half of